

HUM 2101: Sociology and Disaster Management

Significance of Sociology, Social Structure of Bangladesh

Lecture 4.1

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Sociology

- The word “sociology” is derived from the **Latin** word **socius (companion)** and the **Greek** word **logos (speech or reason)**, which together mean “**reasoned speech about companionship**”.
- The sociologist Dorothy Smith defines the social as the
“ongoing concerting and coordinating of individuals’ activities”
- Sociology is the “systematic and scientific study of human behavior, social groups, and society”
- Basic insights
 - Who we are is affected by the groups we belong to
 - Interaction takes place in patterned ways

Areas of sociology

There are seven areas of sociology that includes nearly every topic.

1. **Social organization** is the way a society is organized and the patterns that present themselves among different individuals and social groups.
2. **Social psychology** is the section of psychology that focuses on the presentation and effects of social interaction.
3. **Social change** is how the structure, values, or patterns of a society shift over time.
4. **Human ecology** is the study of how humans relate to their natural, social, and constructed environments.
5. **Population and demographics** are the study of the characteristics groups of individuals with one or more commonalities.
6. **Applied sociology** is the way sociological ideas, concepts, and theories are used to address everyday situations.
7. **Sociological methods and research** are the ways that sociologists study qualitative and quantitative data to learn more about humans and how they function in society.

Key Terms of Sociology

- **Culture** – the total way of life shared by members of a society, including language, values, and material objects.
- **Society** – population that shares the same territory and is bound together by economic and political ties.
- **Values** – shared ideas about desirable goals.
- **Norms** – shared rules of conduct that specify how people ought to think or act.
- **Globalization** – process through which ideas, resources, practices, and people increasingly operate in a worldwide rather than local framework.
- **Socialization** – the process of learning the roles, statuses, and values necessary for participation in social institutions.
- **Conflict** – struggle over scarce resources that is not regulated by shared rules; it may include attempts to destroy, injure, or neutralize one's rivals.
- **Bureaucracy** – a special type of complex organization characterized by explicit rules and hierarchical authority structure, all designed to maximize efficiency.